
Session 23: Graphic Design 3: The "Mini-Agency" Project

Presented by

Ravindu Sooriyaarachchi

Canva



Today, You Are an Art Director

- In the corporate world, you don't just use one software. You use a "stack" of tools to get the job done.
- **Your Stack Today:** Photopea (for heavy image editing) + Canva (for layout and typography).
- **The Goal:** Build a cohesive brand campaign from scratch in under 2 hours.

Meet Your Client: "Nova Smartwear"

The Client:

- A brand-new tech company launching their first smartwatch in Sri Lanka.

Target Audience:

- Fitness enthusiasts and gym-goers.

The Vibe:

- Energetic, modern, and aggressive.

How We Build the Campaign

Phase 1 (Canva):

- Design the Logo & establish the Brand Kit.

Phase 2 (Photopea):

- Retouch the raw watch photo and remove the background.

Phase 3 (Canva):

- Assemble the final Social Media Launch Ad.

Phase 4 (Canva):

- Apply "Mockup Magic" for the client presentation.

Phase 1: The Logo & Brand Kit

- **Action:** Open Canva -> Create "Logo" (500x500).
- **Rules:** Keep it simple! Use ONE icon from the 'Elements' tab and ONE bold, athletic font (like *Anton* or *League Gothic*).
- Choose your **3 Brand Colors** right now (e.g., Black background, White text, Neon Green accents).



Phase 2: Fixing the Product Photo

- **Action:** Download the raw smartwatch photo from the Zoom chat. Open Photopea.com.
- **Rules:**
 - Use the Magic Wand + "Expand & Feather" to smoothly cut out the background.
 - Use *Image* → *Adjustments* to boost the contrast so the watch screen looks bright.
 - Export as a **PNG** so the background stays transparent!



Phase 3: The Launch Ad

- **Action:** Go back to Canva. Create an "Instagram Post (Square)".
- **Upload:** Bring your Phase 1 Logo and your Phase 2 Watch PNG into your Canva 'Uploads'.
- **The Text Required:** "The All-New Nova Watch" | "Track Your Fitness." | "Shop Now at novasmart.lk"
- **The Checklist:** Are you using the Z-Pattern? Is your text properly aligned to the left or right?



URGENT EMAIL FROM THE CLIENT!

- "Hey team, the CEO just decided we are giving away a free sports strap with every watch. We need to add this to the poster before it launches in 10 minutes!"
- **Action:** You must adapt! Go to Canva Elements, find a "Badge" or "Starburst" shape, make it your bright accent color, and add the text "**FREE STRAP INCLUDED!**" somewhere on your design without ruining the layout.



Stop Naming Files "Untitled_Design(1)"

- If you send a file named download(5).png to a boss, it looks incredibly unprofessional.
- **The Corporate Standard:**
ClientName_ProjectName_Version.png
- **Action:** Rename your final Canva file to NovaWatch_LaunchAd_v1.png before you download it.



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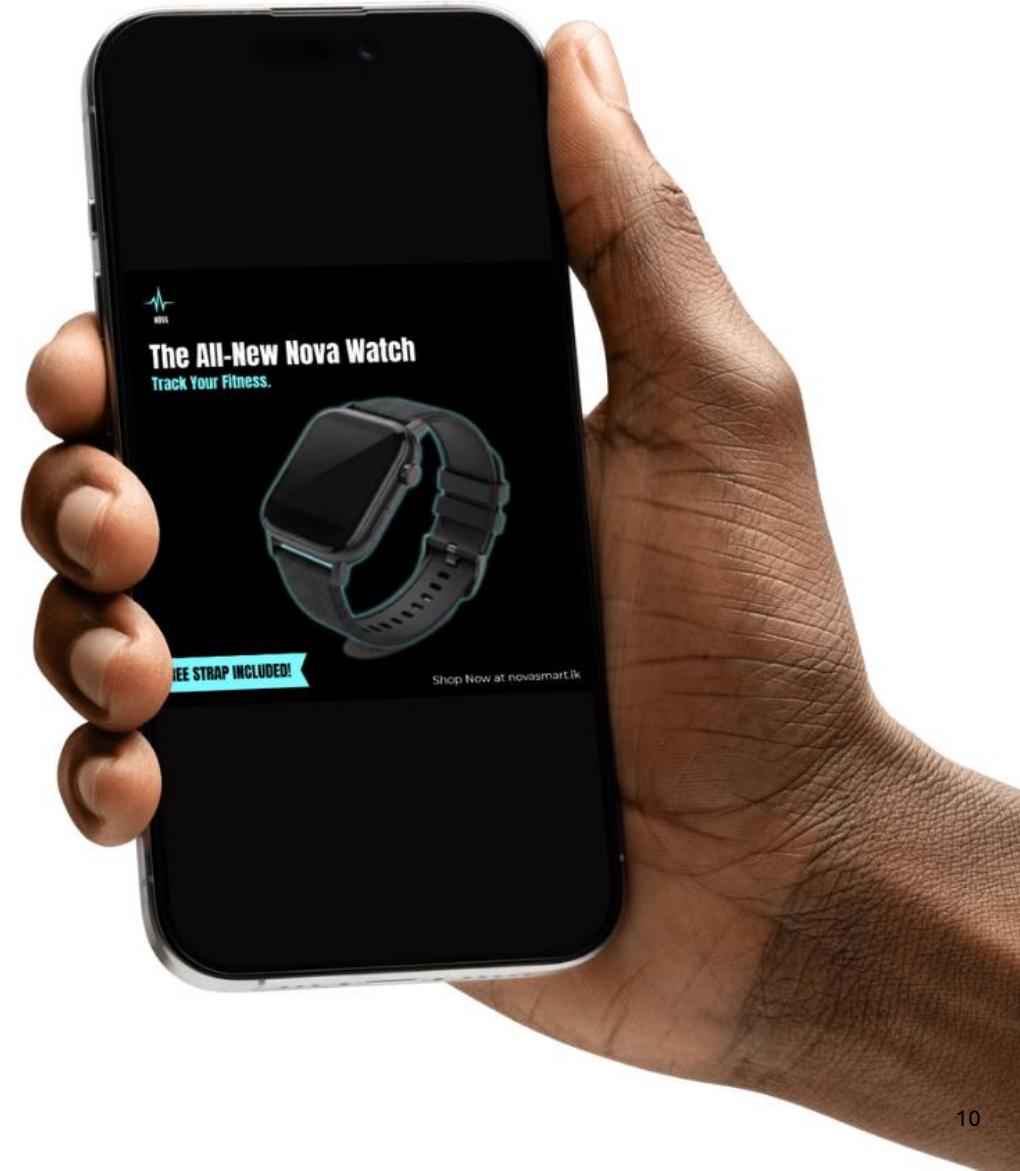
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Presenting Like a Pro

- Clients don't want to see a flat square; they want to see what it looks like in real life.
- Action:
 1. Download your final NovaWatch_LaunchAd_v1.png.
 2. In Canva, open a new blank Presentation slide.
 3. Go to the left menu, click **Apps**, and search for **Mockups**.
 4. Choose a picture of a Smartphone, and drag your Ad into the phone screen.
- Notice how it instantly looks like a million-dollar agency campaign!



Time is Up! Pitch Your Campaign

- Export your final Smartphone Mockup as a PNG.
- Upload it to the class ZOOM Chat.
- Be prepared to unmute your microphone and explain *why* you chose your colors based on the "Fitness Enthusiast" target audience.

You Are Now Visual Communicators

- You have mastered Layouts (Canva), Photo Manipulation (Photopea), and Data Visualization.
- Keep these files safe! In our Grand Finale (Session 24), we will upload these exact Nova Watch mockups into your brand-new Digital Portfolios!

Send Me Your Thoughts (Anonymously!)

*Scan the QR code and share your
questions or feedback*

<https://forms.gle/oKg7kAJNLI3Gcv7n7>

Thank You!

